FORGE Phase 1 · Week 3 · Session 7 — Media Insert

For the facilitator. Use alongside "Session 7: Understanding Emotions" in the Phase 1 Facilitator Guide.

Download the videos: forgementors.org/media.html

Session 7 as written already runs the full two hours (120 minutes). This insert adds three short videos; the run of show has no outside talk (an optional one is listed below). The videos take about nine minutes, and those minutes come out of the Instruction segment, because the videos deliver part of what that segment teaches.

What's in this insert

- **Video 7A, "Understanding Emotions"** (2 min 22 s). Last week was the head, this week is the heart; the week's three steps (recognize, regulate, understand); FORGE is not therapy but a life skill; "the toughest men aren't the ones who feel nothing"; and what today holds. It ends on the check-in question and holds it for 20 seconds.
- **Video 7C, "The Emotion Wheel"** (3 min 6 s; added October 2026, plays between 7A and 7B). The guide's Part 1 with the wheel on screen: the primary emotions in the center, then the words around anger, sadness, fear and joy, one slice at a time; the new vocabulary ("I'm resentful," not "I'm angry"); and "disrespected and hurt" as two things to work with. It ends on the full wheel, held for 90 seconds, so the men can pick their three words without a printout. Pause on that frame for as long as the exercise needs.
- **Handout, "The Emotion Wheel"** (one page, on forgementors.org/media.html). The guide's printout, one per participant. If you can't print it yet, use Video 7C instead and have the men write their three words in their journals.
- **Video 7B, "Anger Is the Bodyguard"** (2 min 2 s). Anger as a secondary emotion, the six emotions anger covers up (fear, shame, hurt, rejection, powerlessness, grief) one at a time on screen, which emotions are safe to show in here, and the guide's phone-call example. It ends on the guide's question, "How many of you have lived that exact scenario, or something like it?", held for 12 seconds.
- **No talk in the run of show.** The session is full as written; an optional talk is listed below for a make-up session or a segment that runs short.

Run of show (120 minutes)

Time	Segment	Min	Notes
0:00	**Video 7A, "Understanding Emotions"**	3	Play it as soon as the men are seated, with the talking piece ready.
0:03	Opening Circle	10	Start the round on the question the video ends on. Go first and model a specific emotion, as written. Don't correct anyone who says "good."
0:13	Review & Reflection	10	As written: the STOP practice, then "How many emotions can you name?" The video does not give away the answer, so the "four to six" point still lands.

Time	Segment	Min	Notes
0:23	**Video 7C, "The Emotion Wheel"**	3	Plays at the start of Part 1. It covers the guide's explanation and ends on the full wheel for the exercise.
0:26	Instruction, Part 1 (rest): the exercise	10	Pause the video on the full wheel. Each man picks three emotions from the last 24 hours (not "angry," "sad" or "fine") and circles them on a printed wheel or writes them in his journal. Let a few share, as written. Two minutes shorter than written.
0:36	**Video 7B, "Anger Is the Bodyguard"**	3	Plays at the start of Part 2 of the Instruction segment.
0:39	Instruction, Part 2 (rest): Anger as a Secondary Emotion	11	The video has given the bodyguard idea, the six emotions and the phone call. Pause and let its closing question land; some men will nod and some will look away. Then give the guide's "look beneath the anger" paragraph.
0:50	Instruction, Part 3: Body Signals	10	As written.
1:00	Practice: Body Mapping	30	As written: 15 minutes mapping, 15 minutes debrief.
1:30	Debrief & Discussion	20	As written ("Why don't men talk about emotions?"). Video 7A already used two of this segment's lines ("a man who doesn't know what he feels…" and "the toughest men…"). Say them again in your own words; they carry more weight from you.
1:50	Checkout & Assignment	10	As written.

If you run short or long

- **Running long** (common when the check-in round is slow): shorten the Part 1 sharing after the circling exercise, not the body mapping.
- **Running short**: replay Video 7B from **0:24 to 0:51** (the six emotions anger covers) before the body mapping debrief and ask which of the six each man recognizes in his own map.

Optional talk (if time allows)

Session 7 already runs two hours, so this talk is not in the run of show above. Use it for a make-up session, when a segment runs short, or for your own preparation before the week.

Eldra Jackson III, ***How I unlearned dangerous lessons about masculinity*** (TED, TEDWomen 2018, 11 minutes 12 seconds). He served 24 years of a life sentence in California. Raised on "big boys don't cry," he didn't know "how to display any emotion confidently other than anger." At New Folsom Prison he joined Inside Circle, a group for incarcerated men, and there he dropped the fronts he hid behind and faced the secret underneath them. He was paroled in 2014 and now lets his sons see him cry. He calls what he works against "this cycle of emotional illiteracy."

Discussion questions:

1. He says that growing up he couldn't show any emotion confidently except anger. Look at the emotion wheel. What feelings has anger covered for you? Use the specific words.
2. "Big boys don't cry." "Suck it up." What did you hear growing up about feelings, and what did it teach you to do with fear or sadness?
3. Asked in circle who he was, he had no honest answer, only fronts like a set name or a street name. On stage he says he feels "raw and naked." Which word on the wheel fits that? When did you last feel it, and what did you do with it?
4. He now lets his sons see him cry. Who could you show one emotion other than anger to, and which one?

Preview it first. He names the crimes he served time for (kidnapping, robbery, attempted murder) and says that in prison he stabbed another man nearly 30 times. He says briefly, without detail, that a babysitter sexually abused him when he was seven and that he kept it secret for decades. That may hit hard for some men, so check in afterwards with anyone who goes quiet. There is one swear word ("bullshit").

- **YouTube** (TED): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_vCIktrORFU
- Also on TED.com: https://www.ted.com/talks/eldra_jackson_how_i_unlearned_dangerous_lessons_about_masculinity

TED allows a single talk in a single lesson, with credit to TED. A talk that becomes a standing part of a curriculum "may require a separate license," and TED asks that talks not be scraped from its site. FORGE repeats every cohort and the prison has no internet, so write to TED (help.ted.com, licensing) for an offline copy for a nonprofit, no-fee, in-prison program. Show it whole and unedited, with TED's title card, and check it against the facility's rules for outside media first.

Getting a copy you can play without internet

All three videos are FORGE's own. Download them from forgementors.org/media.html onto the playback device before the session; they play in any video player and need no internet connection. Captions are burned in.

Checklist additions

- ☐ Videos 7A, 7C and 7B loaded on the playback device and tested with sound
- ☐ Emotion wheel printouts, one per participant, if you can print them (if not, Video 7C shows the wheel; check the men have journals and pens)
- ☐ Player positioned so every chair in the circle can see the screen